LECTURE 10
THE WAR OF INDEPENDENCE

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OUTLINE: LECTURE 10

The War of Independence

Learning Objectives:

- **Recognize that the war of independence was the culmination of decades of struggle for social, economic, cultural, political emancipation of the people of Bangladesh**
- **Trace the events from the 1969 mass uprising to the start of the genocide by Pakistan on March 26th 1971**
- **Identify the critical leaders in Bangladesh and their contributions during the war of independence**
- **Identify the war criminals and their role in the genocide and the killing of Bengalee intellectuals**
- **Describe the role of superpowers and the global support for Bangladesh in the war of independence**

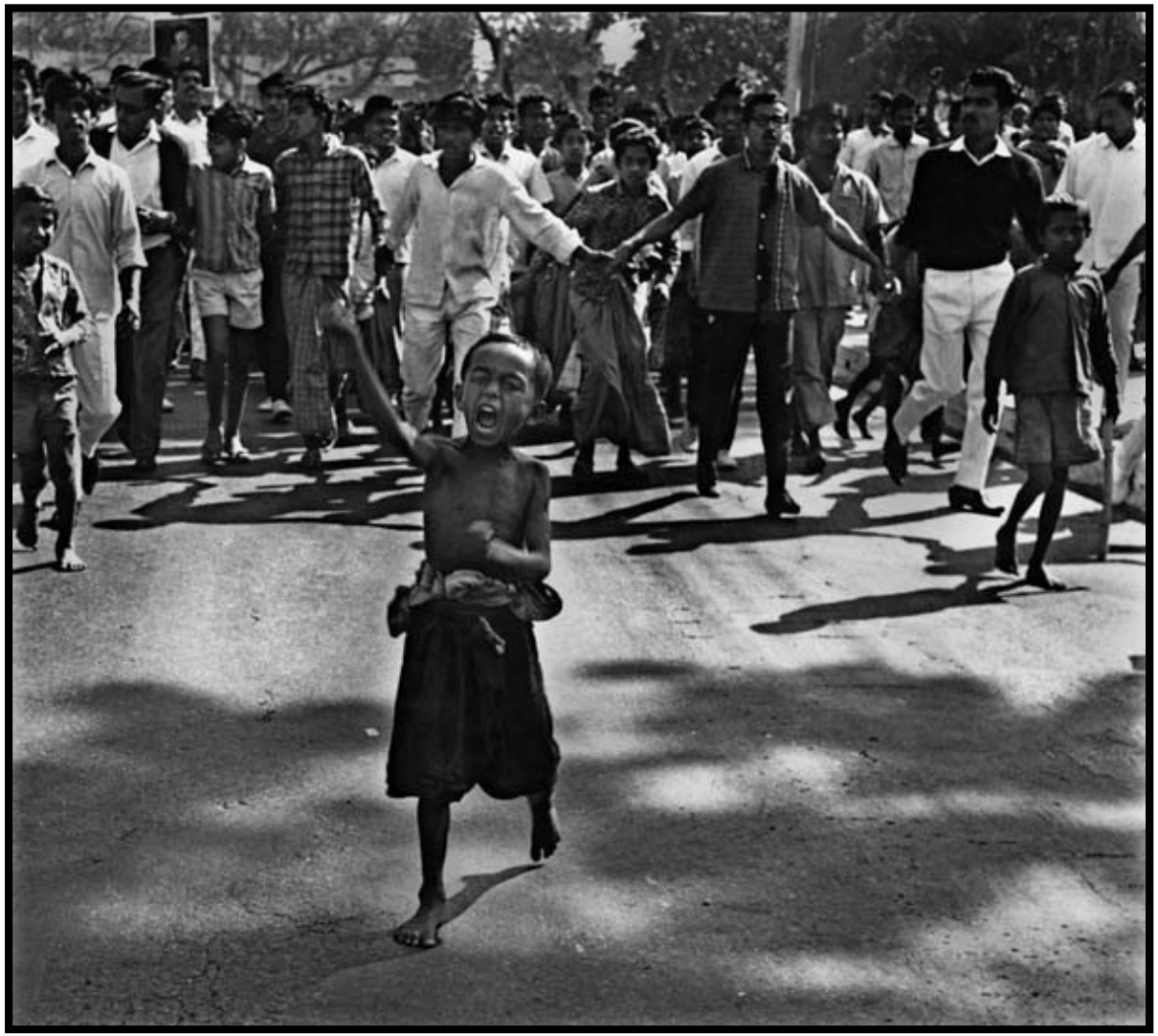
FROM OPPRESSION TO EMANCIPATION

- Movement against the denial of Bengali language and culture
- Movement against economic exploitation, regional disparity, income inequality & impoverishment of rural peasantry
- Movement against discrimination in administration, justice & national security
- Movement against oppression of the military bureaucratic state



MASS UPSURGE, 1969 AND FALL OF AYUB KHAN

- 1968 Agartala Conspiracy Case and the arrest of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman fuelled a mass movement in the East
- All parties of Pakistan came under one demand for the fall of Ayub Khan
- Protest rallies, student agitation and labor strikes increased in intensity
- March 25, 1969 Ayub relinquished his presidency



RISE OF ANOTHER MILITARY DICTATOR: GENERAL YAHYA

- Ayub Khan handed over power to Army Commander Gen Yahya Khan
- Martial law was declared
- Chief Martial Law Administrator Gen Yahya Khan on March 31, 1969 declared himself President
- Election through universal adult franchise was promised
- National Assembly of 300 seats to include 162 from EP and 138 from WP



NOVEMBER 1970: CYCLONE AND ITS IMPACT

- **On the night between 12 & 13 November, 1970, East Pakistan's coastline was struck by a major cyclone accompanied by high tidal waves**
- **Over half a million people were killed**
- **The Pakistan state wasn't even aware; later in denial; and then sent very little relief and way too late**
- **Massive civilian mobilization and foreign relief efforts helped in the recovery**

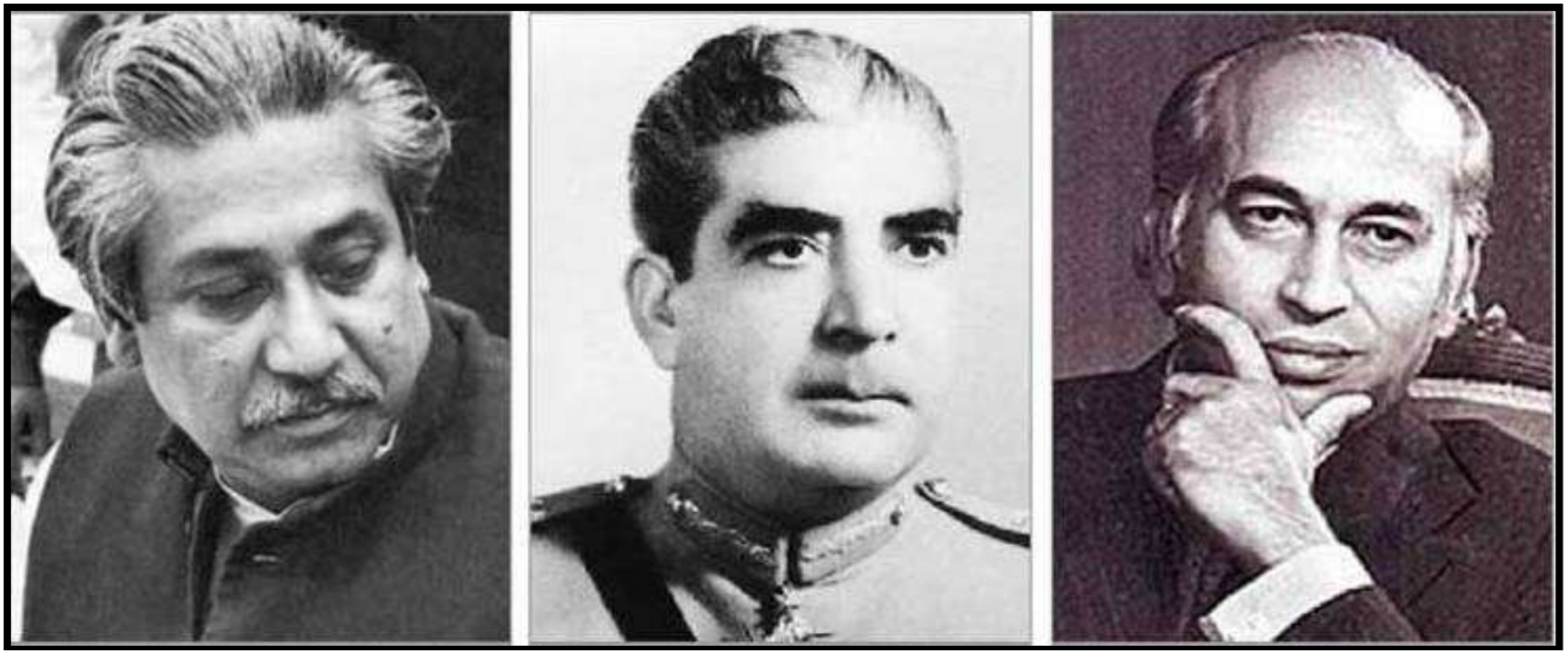
East Pakistan realized through this experience, the insensitivity of the Pakistanis towards them

1970 ELECTION AND LANDSLIDE VICTORY

- **Bangbandhu led Awami League won a landslide victory on the basis of the six point demand**

  - 160 out of 162 seats in EP ; total seats in Pakistan - 300

- **Bhutto's PPP won 81 seats; all in WP**
- **Absolute victory of Awami League energized EP demand for freedom and regional autonomy**



POST-ELECTION EVENTS

- Bhutto refuses to allow Mujib to form government
- January 17, 1971: Yahya visits Bhutto in Larkana with military generals and draws up plan for military action in EP
- Pak military in EP strengthened and prepared for Operation Blitz
- March 1: Yahya postpones convening of Parliament
- Bengalis realize Pakistan cannot be trusted to hand over power
- Non Cooperation Movement starts
- March 2: Students hoist flag of BD at Dhaka University
- March 3: Students read out Manifesto of BD Independence
- March 7: Mujib calls on people to resist conspiracies and prepare for struggle for freedom and independence
- March: Yahya and Bhutto hold meetings with Mujib and AL but secretly prepare for genocide
- March 25: Operation Searchlight and mass killings start under General Khadim Hussain Raja
- March 26: Bangabandhu declares independence of Bangladesh

MARCH 2 AND MARCH 7, 1971





OPERATION SEARCHLIGHT: MILITARY CRACKDOWN

In Dhaka targeted attacks with tanks and artillery on

- **student halls**
- **university teachers**
- **HQ of Police and East Pakistan Rifles**
- **Hindu residential areas**
- **urban slums**





DECLARATION OF INDEPENDENCE

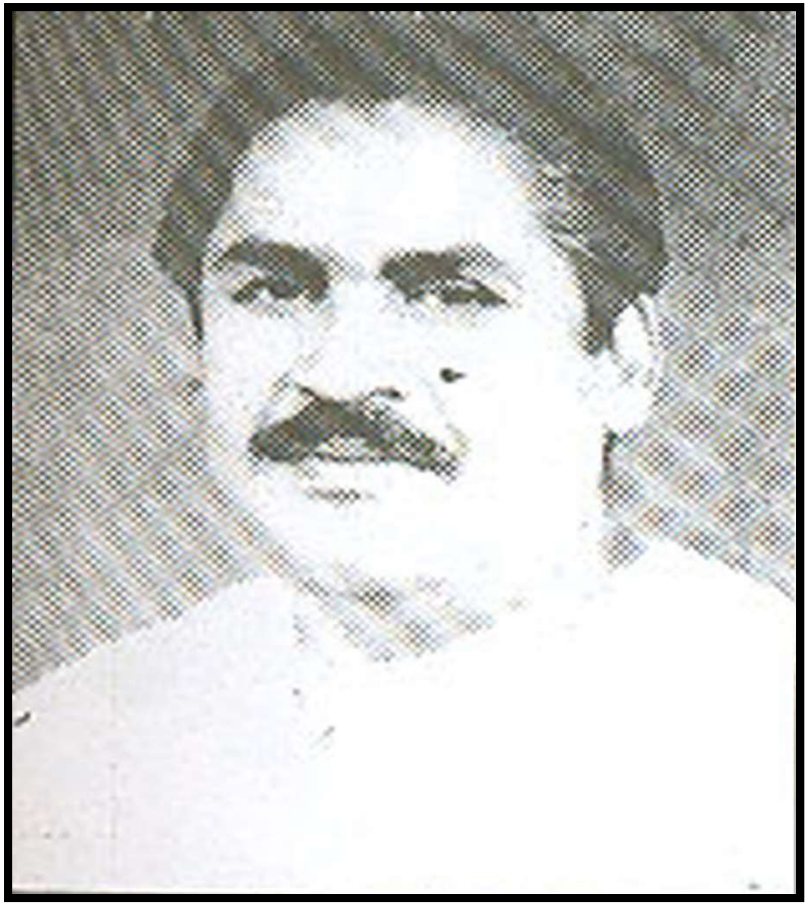
- **March 26, 1971: Before his arrest, Bangabandhu declared independence of Bangladesh transmitted through EPR wireless**

"This may be my last message. From today Bangla Desh is independent. I call upon the people of Bangla Desh, wherever you are and with whatever you have, to resist the army of occupation to the last. Your fight must go on until the last soldier of the Pakistan occupation army is expelled from the soil of Bangla Desh and final victory is achieved."

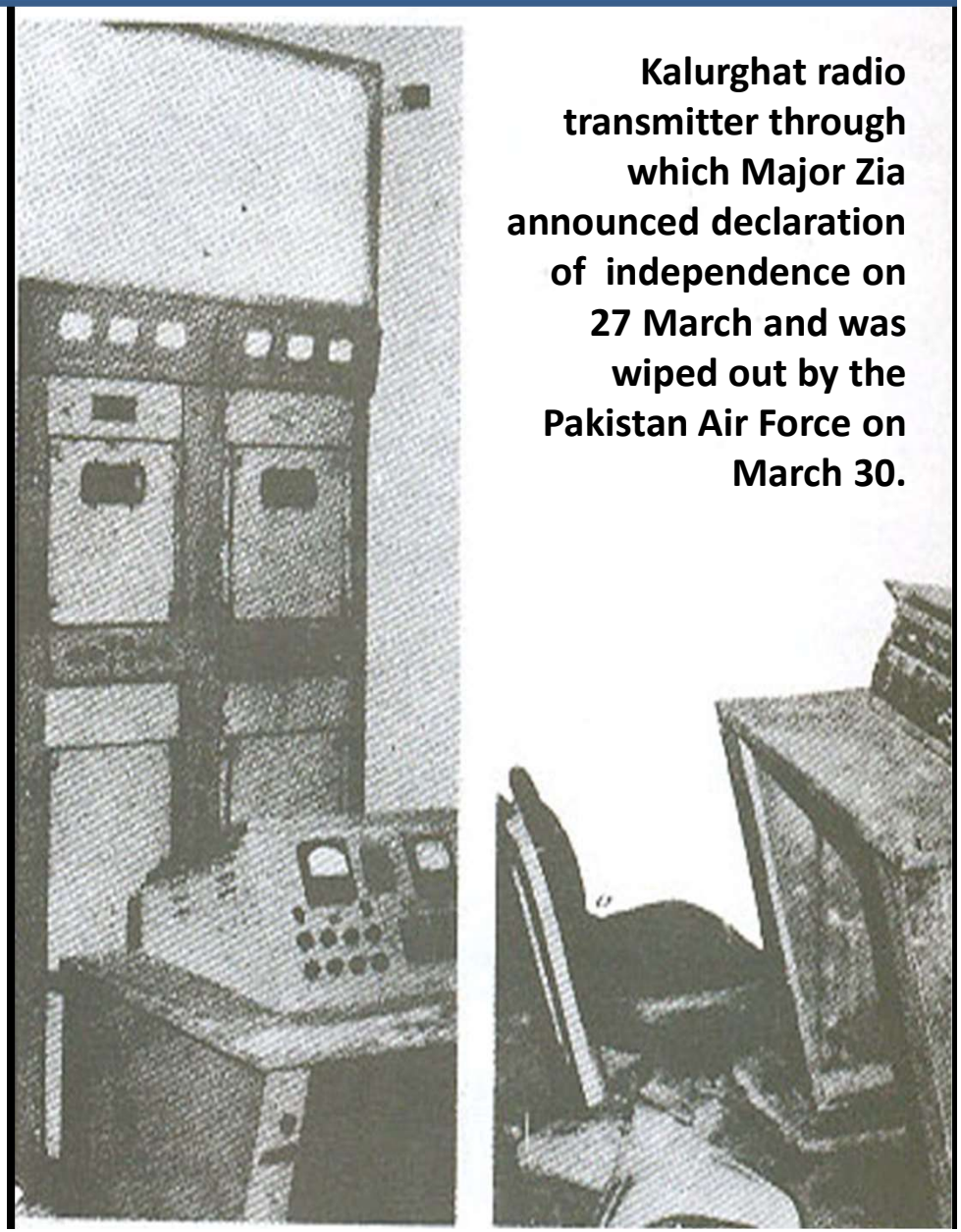
- **March 26, 2:30 PM: AL Leader M A Hannan broadcasts message from Chittagong Radio**
- **March 26 and 27: broadcasts from Kalurghat radio station by Swadhin Bangla Betar Kendra**
- **March 27, 7:30 PM: Major Zia announces independence and military revolt from Kalurghat radio station**

Zia's announcement (on Bangabandhu's behalf) was heard by many more than earlier announcements and had a strong impact

DECLARATION OF INDEPENDENCE



M A Hannan in Chittagong played a crucial role in the declaration of independence by Sheikh Mujib on 26 March



Kalurghat radio transmitter through which Major Zia announced declaration of independence on 27 March and was wiped out by the Pakistan Air Force on March 30.

GOVERNMENT-IN-EXILE



- Acting President - Syed Nazrul Islam
- Prime Minister - Tajuddin Ahmed
- Commander of BD Mukti Bahini – Colonel M A G Osmani
- A small cabinet was also formed

- Formed on April 10, 1971
- Took oath on April 17, 1971 at Mujibnagar, Meherpur, Kushtia
- Mujib declared president of BD



MUKTI BAHINI AND ARMED STRUGGLE

- ***Mukti Bahini*** **also known as freedom fighters**
- **Mujibnagar Government formed Mukti Bahini under the command of Colonel M A G Osmani**
- **War strategy mainly was guerilla warfare**
- **Regular and irregular forces were formed**
- **The country was divided into eleven sectors**





MUKTI BAHINI AND ARMED STRUGGLE



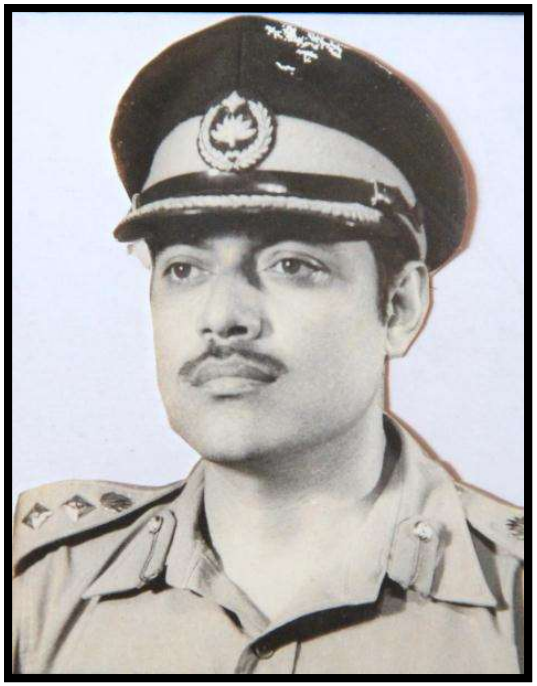
Eleven Sector Commanders

Colonel Osmani (centre) **with Bangladesh sector commanders** (1971). *Photo courtesy:* ***Unknown***

OTHER FORCES



Z force
Ziaur Rahman



K force
Khaled Mosharraf



S force
K.M. Saffiullah

OTHER FORCES

- **Other forces:**
  - ✓ **Mujib Bahini**
  - ✓ **Kader Bahini**
  - ✓ **Some other leftist forces**

- **Brigade forces:**
  - ✓ **Z force- Ziaur Rahman**
  - ✓ **K force- Khaled Mosharraf**
  - ✓ **S force- K.M. Saffiullah**

- **Naval and air wings**

- **Crack platoon of Mukti Bahini was very active in occupied Dhaka and kept people's morale high**

MUKTI BAHINI



MUKTI BAHINI

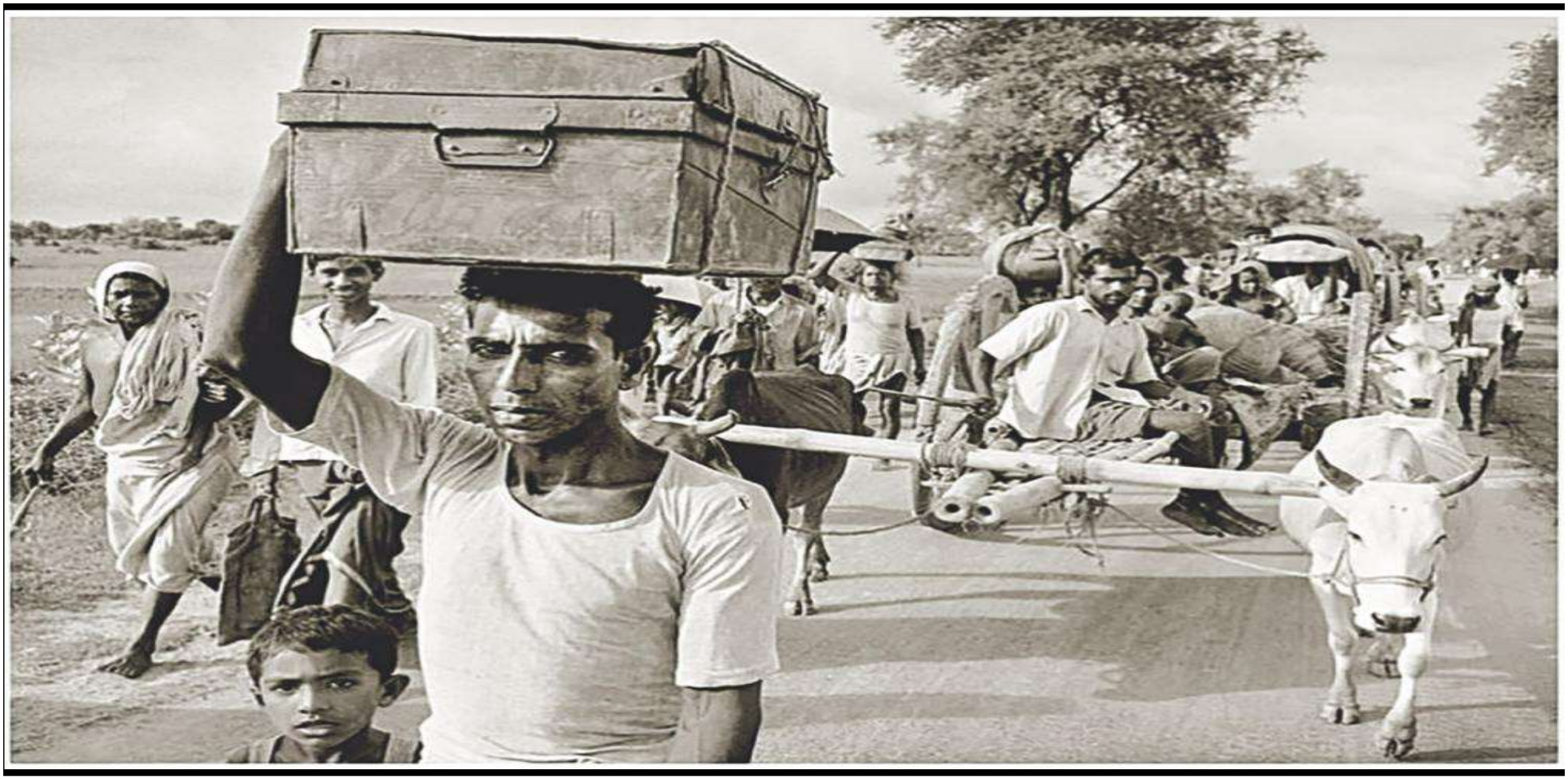








REFUGEES



- **10 million Bangladeshis fled to India as refugees**

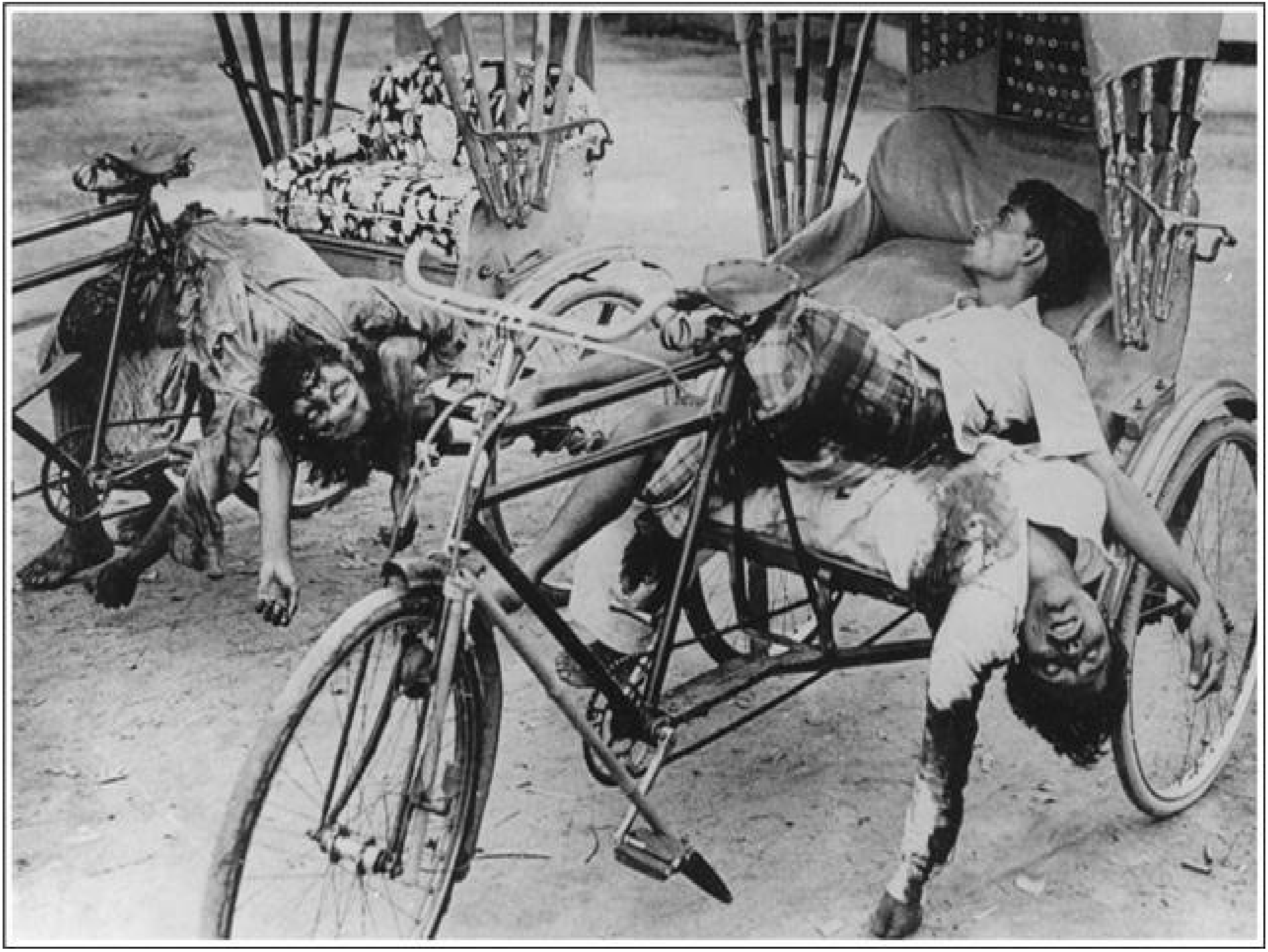
WAR ON CULTURAL FRONT

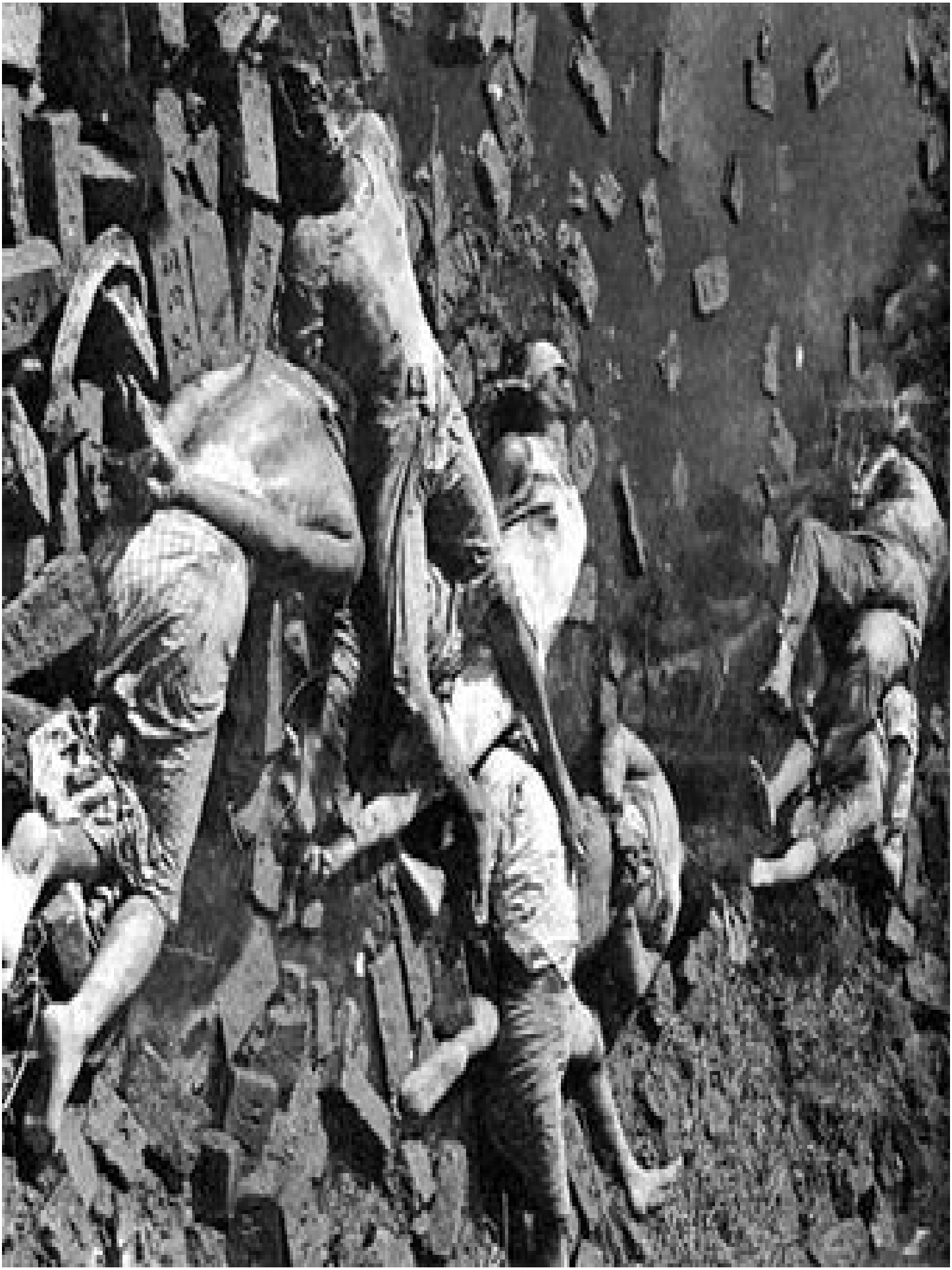
- **Shadhin Bangla Betar Kendro inspired the people through news and commentary on the war and the heroism of the Mukti Bahini and cultural programs to keep morale high**



WAR CRIMES IN 1971























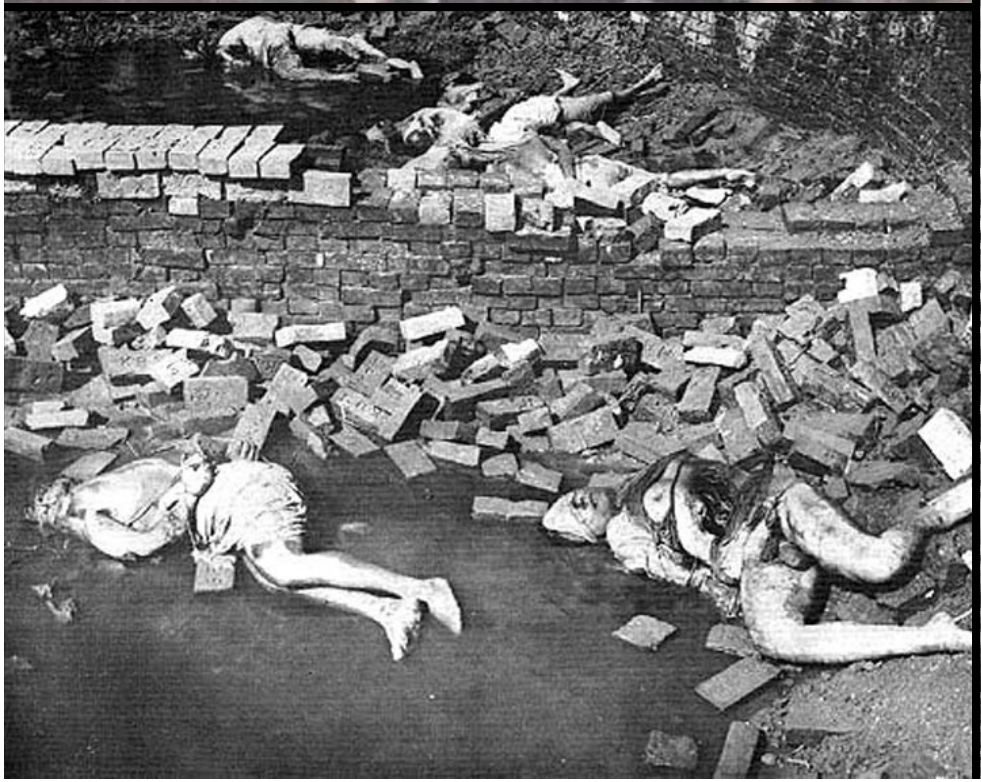




















KILLING OF INTELLECTUALS


Rashidul Hasan


Dr. Fazle Rabbi


Ghyasuddin Ahmed


ANM Mustafa


Dhirendra Nath Dutta


Dr. Azharul Haque


Dr G C Dev


Danbir Ranada Prasad Saha


Anudvaipayan Bhattacharya


Altaf Mahmud

14th December Intellectuals Martyrs Day



Munier Choudhury



Serajuddin Hossain



Dr. Alim Chowdhury



Mofazzal Haidar Chaudhury



Shahidullah Kaiser



Nizamuddin Ahmed



Anwar Pasha



Syed Nazmul Haque



Syed Abdul Mannan



Dr. Abul Kalam Azad



Dr. MAM Faizul Mahi



Dr. MA Khair



Zahirul Haq



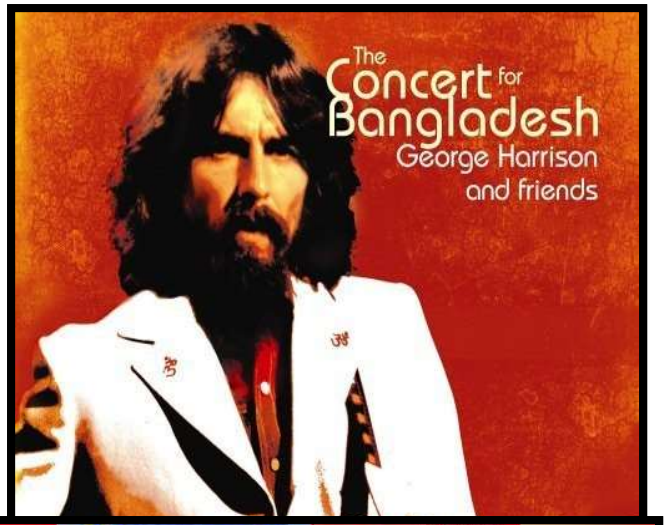
Selina Parvin



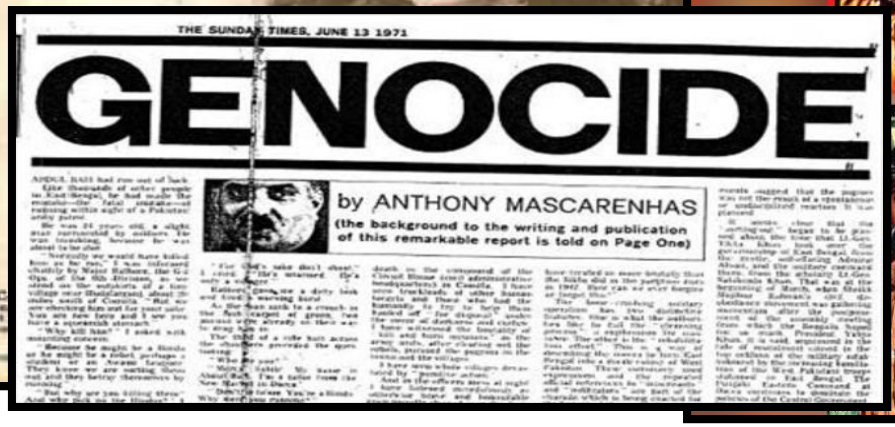
Dr. Santosh Bhattacharya

GLOBAL SUPPORT FOR BANGLADESH

- Local media couldn't cover the liberation war stories and Pakistani atrocities
- International media wholeheartedly stood beside the oppressed people of Bangladesh
- Concert for Bangladesh was organized and drew huge global attention









ROLE OF SUPERPOWERS

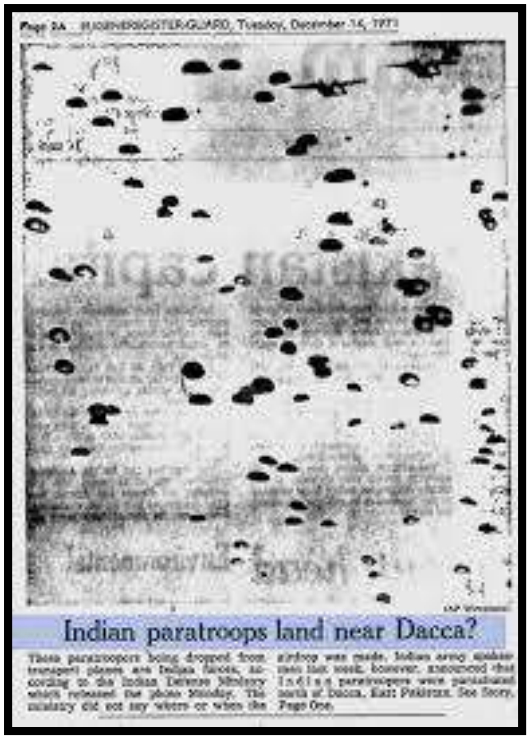
- Cold War impacted on the liberation war and its outcomes
- Role of USA
- Role of Soviet Russia
- Role of China
- Indo-Soviet Friendship Treaty
- United Nations Security Council events

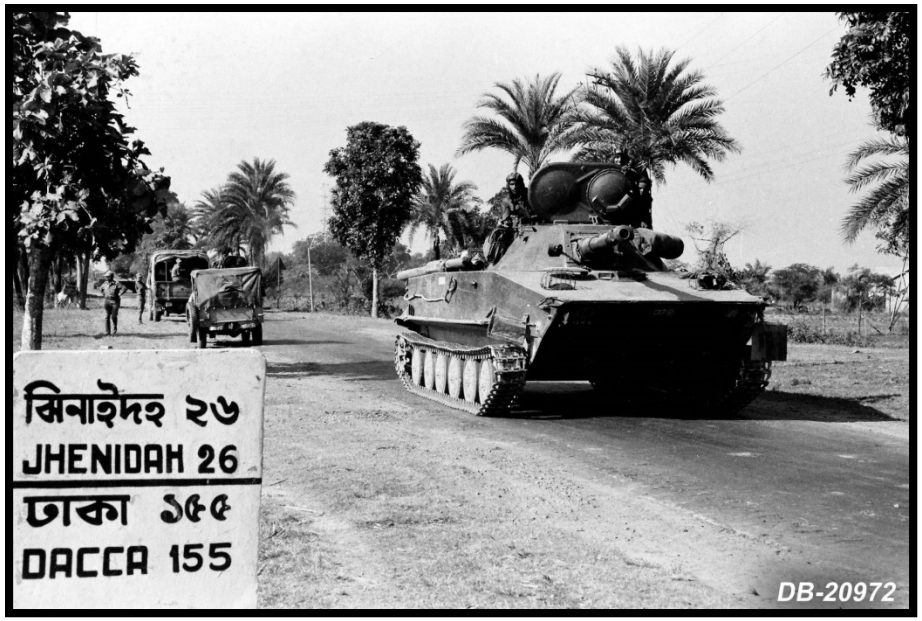




THE 14 DAY INDO-PAK WAR: DECEMBER 3-16

- Yahya Khan instructed the army to attack on western part of India. But it failed to distract India from East Pakistan.
- As a result, India-Pakistan war broke out.
- In December, Pakistani soldiers were already in total disaster caused by the Mukti Bahini attacks.
- Mukti Bahini gave all information about the ground and the strategic enemy lines.


Indian paratroops land near Dacca?



- India launched cross border operation on December 4, 1971 to expel Pakistani army from East Pakistan
- Thousands of Indian troops with support of navy and air force set their foots on Bangladeshi soil

THE SURRENDER OF THE PAKISTANI FORCES



Lieutenant General Niazi being escorted by Lieutenant General Aurora and Major ATM Haider for the signing of the Instrument of Surrender on 16 December 1971.



Lieutenant General Niaz signing the Instrument of Surrender

THE LIBERATION DAY

- December 16, 1971 is the victory day of Bangladesh
- A new country was born based on Bengalee nationalism





- Jubilant crowds celebrate the great victory against the powerful Pakistan military forces

SEVEN BIRSRESHTHO



Mahiuddin Jahangir
(1948-1971)



Matiur Rahman
(1941-1971)



Ruhul Amin
(1935-1971)



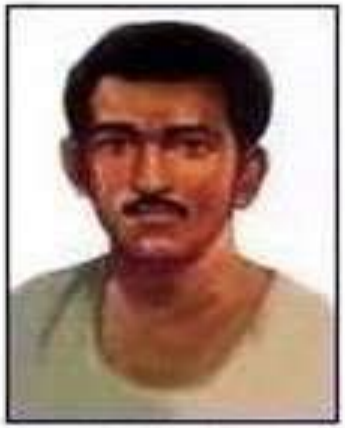
Nur Mohammad Sheikh
(1936-1971)



Munshi Abdur Rauf
(1943-1971)



Mohammad Mostafa Kamal
(1947-1971)



Mohammad Hamidur Rahman
(1945-1971)

welovebd.com

WE ARE BANGLADESH!

